

Crack the code

10 Solve the two part puzzle in pages 44 and 126 of the magazine

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13 In 1972, which spacecraft used the Intel 4004?

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15 By what name was Wikipedia started?

Programming Principles

When coding an application, there are a number of approaches that a programmer can take. Some of the more popular guidelines help making simpler, faster, easy to use programs.

POGE: stands for "Principle of Good Enough" - it basically means that if even a basic, bareboned approach get's the job done, it's better than a feature rich application. That is, once the software starts doing what it is supposed to do, stop developing it and adding in more functionality and options.

DRY: stands for "Don't repeat yourself", which is pretty difficult to comprehend for non-programmers. It means that you do not use redundant code and approaches.

KISS: Keep It Simple, Stupid is pretty self explanatory. However, software developers often argue that the principle is erroneously named, and the "stupid" should be kicked to make the principle just "KIS", for the sake of simplicity.

RAD: Rapid Application Development is a philosophy used by coders who just want to start coding, and let the application evolve over time to whatever it turns out to be without planning what it needs to do too much in advance. RAD encourages frenzied coding, which is what many programmers do best.

BDD: Behavior Driven Development is a modern philosophy, emerging to bridge the divide between software creation and it's use. The developers often create applications based on an understanding of how they would like to use the software, instead of the people who actually buy and use the software. BDD seeks extensive feedback from the users during the release cycle.

BDUF: the Big Design Up Front approach goes against many coding philosophies, including POGE and KISS. BDUF calls for developers to plan for complex and large projects well in advance, instead of letting a bareboned version evolve over time.

XP: eXtreme programming is an approach that allows software to rapidly evolve. All the normal procedures of software development are pushed to their extreme limits, with a lot of feedback from users, continuous releases, and constant bug fixing, patching and other changes.



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digit DIARY

The seeds that you recieved in this month's issue are a culmination of almost four months of planning. The idea was initially pitched by Siddharth, and then everyone in the company went around hunting for seeds that could be distributed easily and yet grow into full grown seeds. The problem was that trees were usually planted as saplings, but nature itself came to our rescue. The seeds of the trees packaged with Digit, are tall, and take up a lot of room, which meant their seeds had to move far away from the trees before being able to germinate, which meant the seeds had to be small and light.

Which is why we could give the seeds along with our Magazine. We planted the trees in many locations, to check out how well they grew. Aditya managed to pick absolutely the worst location possible, by planting a seed in a divider. Additionally, this was the very divider where another office would empty buckets of dirty Air-Conditioner refuse water.

The plants that were growing on the divider itself became stunted over time. These are trees people, not plants, so don't waste the seeds in flower pots. Rossi went around Vashi planting the trees in different locations, then discovered the starting in a cup trick. This actually bore a small plant, which we are proud to say is well on it's way to treehood now.

Flash Games: Vector Runner



"Vector Runner" is one of those games that you cannot stop playing even if your boss is looking over your shoulder and piling work on your desk. The game uses basic shapes, a cube as a block, smaller cubes as power-ups, and a steady stream of pyramids and rhombuses to dodge. The game is addictive because of the three challenges, of how far you can go without hitting something. This is one of those games that you can play for short bursts whenever you feel like a break. Despite how simple the game looks, the gameplay is pretty complex, and the game is by no means easy.